SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

HUMAN RIGHTS AWARENESS AND WILLINGNESS TO REPORT ABUSES: A QUANTITATIVE STUDY

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CHAPTER I

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1. Background of the Study

Human rights are basic freedoms owed to everyone by virtue of being human. These rights include civil, social, and economic guarantees, such as the right to life, democracy, free speech, and fairness under the law. They are prerequisites for society's survival and a vision for a just, peaceful world (Nowak, 2022; Rastogi, 2014). Addressing violations, preventing abuses, promoting equality, and encouraging democratic participation are essential for safeguarding human dignity (Ashifa, 2020).

Educating people about their rights empowers them to recognize and exercise those rights, preventing abuse and fostering respect (Singh, 2015). It underscores the importance of education in reaching vulnerable groups who are often left out of formal systems (Cassel, 2004; Ohlin, 2017).

Human rights stem from humanity's persistent demand for justice and freedom (Agaarwal, 2014). The UN works to protect these values and promote global equality (Akani, 2020; Mutua, 2017). Knowing human rights is key to defending them, yet many remain unaware of them. While institutions help enforce rights, knowledge is the first line of defense. Studies show that more people have average levels of human rights awareness than high levels (Agarwal, 2014).

Though many people in the Philippines know the basics, such as the right to live freely, freedom of expression, and equality under the law, awareness often remains superficial. Awareness in the Philippines is often limited to rights taught in school or discussed in the media. The CHR notes knowledge of advanced rights, such as due process and socioeconomic protections, is weak (Ismaili, 2024). Urban areas show more awareness due to better access to campaigns and education, while marginalized groups have less (Reuter, 2019). Cultural attitudes, distrust, poverty, and limited civic education contribute to these gaps. Sustained school and community programs can help communities better stand up for their rights (Adetayo, 2024).

This Study will examine how the level of human rights awareness among communities in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte influences their willingness to report abuse cases. By identifying the factors that shape both awareness and reporting behavior, the research seeks to clarify the relationship between knowing one's rights and the motivation to seek protection or report infractions.

This Study will help citizens in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte, by raising awareness and encouraging reporting of abuses. It will help law enforcement and government organizations improve advocacy, close knowledge gaps, and strengthen reporting. Teachers and advocacy groups can use these findings to design initiatives that support education and reporting systems.

These results will help develop policies, campaigns, and interventions to empower communities to recognize and act on human rights violations. This Study will assist future

researchers by providing baseline data and insights into the links between rights awareness and reporting behavior, enabling expanded and comparative studies.

1.2.Review of Related Literature

Individuals acquire information and develop an understanding of the value of human rights, which enables them to recognize appropriate responses when instances of abuse are disclosed (Misra, 2023). Human dignity is fundamental and underpins human rights, which possess universal legal significance and support fairness, equality, and liberty (Hasegawa, 2024). The core tenets of human rights sustain personal freedom and strengthen community cohesion, and encourage individual and collective development (Batista, 2023). Commitment to these values extends beyond legal compliance; it shapes educational approaches, governmental decisions, and social norms contributing to societal advancement grounded in fairness, collaboration, and equal opportunities for all.

Rights may be broadly classified as natural rights, legal rights, free and equal in dignity and right to life, liberty and security, right to recognition as person before the law, proper to privacy, Freedom of Opinion and Expression, Freedom of Assembly Participation in Government and Association, Right to Education, Right to Culture freedom of movement, right to nationality, right to Marry right to Property, freedom of thought, conscience and religion e.t.c (Dzhuska et al., 2021).Generally, human rights can be categorized into civil rights, political rights, and financial, social, and cultural rights. These two kinds of rights document the core sections of global people rights; these folks make up the first part of the 1948 Universal Declaration of Human Rights (with economic, societal, and cultural entitlements making up part two) (Weber, 2024).

The lack of promotion and practice of human rights has had a significant impact in widening the gap between the rich and the poor in society. The rise of human rights activism in

the 1960s and 1970s brought with it a growing recognition of the potential of the human rights framework to effect social change and the importance of human rights awareness for all segments of society (Whelan & Donnelly, 2020). However, in the United States, human rights education is still in its beginning stages. Human rights education promotes democratic principles in India and many other countries (Parker, 2018). Human rights education also helps to develop communication skills (McLeod, 2018). Human rights education engages the heart as well as the mind. Human rights education makes a formal declaration about the interdependence of the human family. It promotes understanding of how abuses can be abolished and avoided (Porter, 2020).

Human rights awareness means understanding the fundamental rights and freedoms that every person has. Knowing about human rights helps people recognize when these rights are being violated and encourages them to stand up for fairness and justice (Hareket,2021).Education can greatly help someone understand people's rights. Groups better by far People who learn about fairness and justice tend to voice their thoughts more often opposing unfair treatment while shielding those at risk. Teaching human rights in classrooms, workplaces, and other settings matters for helping folks become more knowledgeable or involved (Lundy & Sainz, 2018).

Human rights awareness has also increased as a result of international initiatives. Amnesty International and the United Nations are two organizations that strive to inform people about their rights and promote action to stop abuses (Connors, 2019). Earlier efforts were released—some real-world, others online — that'll make it easier for folks to start noticing more about humans and what it means to be one right (Sainz and Hanna, 2023). But, particularly

people often struggle even more when trying to reach learning, along with state-imposed boundaries, restricted learning chances however limited supplies. It indicates that, to continuously raise awareness of human rights issues worldwide, cooperation between nations and organizations, clear communication, and ongoing education are required (Swed, 2018).

The ability for folks to learn, apply, or stand up for basic freedoms, particularly during undemocratic actions, risks their liberties while they need safety in society; wellness or calm holds things steady when the rules of law apply, yet welfare. So, a democracy probably won't suffer from functional issues when most of its people know their basic rights and stand up for them. NGOs help address the gap in nations where the state fails to guarantee or enforce the right to free and compulsory elementary school education. They can promote and lobby against governments to fulfill their international obligations to implement the right to education (and then HRE) (Sanders & Scanlon, 2021).

1International Related Studies

Key chances fall under the guidelines that keep people's expectations steady. Sadly, it is no shock when dictators misuse these liberties. When this occurs, composing should take the initiative and assist. Attract attention to such encroachment and help people show compassion towards those whose opportunities are mistreated (Naseem et al., 2023). Human Rights Education (HRE) is broadly understood as a collection of educational, training, awareness-raising, and pedagogical methods designed to inform individuals about human rights norms at international, regional, and national levels and to cultivate the skills, attitudes, and behaviors necessary for their protection and promotion. HRE builds understanding of rights by teaching

facts, abilities, principles, mindsets, and ways of seeing the world, helping everyone respect their own freedoms and those of others. Programs focused on human rights learning, inside or outside classrooms, may strengthen fair decision-making, public involvement, and a sense of belonging, leading to communities that withstand pressure and remain steady. So, integrating human rights lessons into school plans and nationwide laws and regulations in lawmaking and governance, and in the courts, is a key duty for authorities, not just to meet education promises but also to raise awareness of basic rights and guide actions that align with those standards (Soomro et al., 2025).

Physical, emotional, and sexual child abuse are significant problems in South Africa. Of all abuse victims, 85.6% did not receive help due to non-disclosure or inactivity of services, and 14.4% received help: 4.9% from formal health or social services and 7.1% through community vigilante action (Meyer, 2022). Emotional Abuse, sexual Abuse, and female gender were associated with higher odds of help-seeking. While children in South Africa showed high knowledge of available services, access to and receipt of formal services among abused children were low. Notably fewer children received help from formal services than from community vigilante action. Immediate action is needed to improve service access for child abuse victims (Hardyansah et al., 2022).

There is consensus that primary prevention strategies that use multiple approaches and prevention pathways are likely to be most effective (Lonne et al., 2019). For example, parents, friends, and neighbors can all learn to spot danger signs and know what to do when something is off. Teams at work might learn to notice warning signs, speak up when they see harm, and help anyone caught in tough spots (Walsh et al., 2022). Organizations can implement situational

prevention by designing their environments and cultures to prioritize safety and facilitate detection and reporting.

Women were more likely than men to report each crime type, and bystanders who were good friends of the offender were less likely to report than strangers. No two- or three-way interactions were significant. Still, a significant four-way interaction indicated that anonymity, relationship with the offender, and bystander's gender predicted willingness to report for the sexual assault scenario. Being a resident was positively related to willingness to report. Physical and sexual events led to an increased level of desire to report. What seems significant for policy and program is that perceived organizational support for reporting had a negligible effect on willingness to report. At the same time, commitment to residents' well-being was strongly and positively related to that willingness (Rudolph et al., 2024).

Additionally, pushing for spotting harm in care homes might work better if it takes into account how living in care homes relates to stepping up. Besides, noticing damage done or missed tends to gain traction when residents feel more inclined to act because they are part of the place. Since sexual and physical events were most likely to be acted upon, efforts need to be made to mandate in statute and rule that other types of events, such as failure to supervise, failure to provide. Harmful restraint and control should also be reported.

So, knowing basic rights plus feeling ready to speak up shows why teaching people matters everywhere. When folks get more informed, responsibility tends to grow while silence fades. Learning from what has worked around the world can shape smarter initiatives that help

groups spot harm early. These lessons become key to building fairness, respect, and dignity in societies worldwide.

Local Related Studies

National Human Rights Institutions (NHRIs) play a role in pushing for action on major rights abuses by collecting proof, documenting cases, and sometimes urging legal action. Civil society groups (CSOs) might boost prosecution efforts through independent probes and public pressure, alongside backing NHRI work (Jeffrey & Dannhauer, 2024). Recent signs of danger aimed at the Commission on Human Rights (the Commission) in the Philippines underscored the vital role of its ties with civil society. Bodies like the Commission, known as National Human Rights Institutions (NHRIs), are government-backed entities tasked with defending and advancing rights in their countries. Both NHRIs and human rights-focused civil society organisations (CSOs) gather evidence, monitor human rights violations, prepare detailed investigative reports, and in some cases suggest that crimes be prosecuted (Palmer, 2019).

In regions, human rights were taught frequently in ARMM and Region VI, but only occasionally in others. Schools sometimes accept that students may hold views different from those of school authorities. However, the majority believe that teaching students about human rights can sometimes lead them to become activists. Human rights education often reduces human rights violations. Teachers are generally not trained to teach human rights (Robinson et al., 2018). When school authority is placed in peril by students' exercise of human rights, the school would opt to further limit students' rights, thereby creating the perception that human

rights are those the authority grants to the people. Students lack sufficient exposure to recognize the critical role governments play in their constituents' economic lives.

On the other hand, over the years, Abuse in women and children is rising due to several technological, social environment, and psychological factors; however, the Abuse reporting system with analytics is relatively unadopted and unexplored in developing countries, such as the Philippines (Sheikh, 2024). Government agencies have devoted resources to adopting new technologies to improve public service delivery, transparency, safety, and the protection of citizens. Likewise, government decision-makers are supported by Information Technology (IT) solutions to enhance performance and fulfill their roles and functions. For instance, some government agencies responsible for public safety and constituent welfare are equipped with analytics to respond immediately to the needs of vulnerable citizens, such as women and children. However, Abuse of the vulnerable is common but often remains undetected. The reporting of suspected abuse cases to authorities promptly is essential to prevent continued Abuse and protect the vulnerable members of society (Castro, 2019).

In developed countries, individuals are encouraged to report potential or evident Abuse. It is meant to address growing problems in safeguarding efforts and the skill level of people supporting survivors, while boosting community understanding (Mathews, 2022). Whether victims or locals speak up about Abuse often hinges on how well they know their rights, along with how safe they feel under legal protections (Jordan, 2021). The Commission on Human Rights (CHR) points out that fear of backlash, doubt about officials, and a lack of knowledge of one's rights keep many from reporting. Income and social standing matter too, since disadvantaged groups usually struggle more to reach legal help or use reporting options. These

factors highlight the need for continuous public education and accessible reporting systems to encourage victims and witnesses to take action (Palmer, 2019).

Furthermore, it has been emphasized that community support and responsive law enforcement agencies significantly increase the likelihood of reporting Abuse. Programs led by non-governmental organizations (NGOs) and government initiatives, such as the Barangay Violence Against Women and Children (VAWC) desks, have shown positive effects in creating safe spaces for victims to report cases. However, gaps remain in awareness and in the implementation of these services, particularly in rural areas. Boosting awareness of basic rights while building leaders' confidence helps locals feel bolder about calling out harm, so they can stand up and demand fairness when mistreatment occurs.

Respondents' Profile

Age

Age significantly influences individuals' understanding and engagement with human rights issues. According to (Batista, 2023), younger people are more receptive to human rights education due to exposure through formal schooling and social media campaigns, which encourage activism and awareness. In contrast, older populations may exhibit limited understanding of modern human rights concepts due to adherence to traditional beliefs and lack of access to updated information sources. This generational divide demonstrates how different life stages affect one's ability to internalize and act upon human rights principles.

Furthermore, (Hareket, 2021) emphasized that age directly affects the type and quality of human rights information consumed by individuals. Youth and working-age adults are more likely to access rights-related materials online, while older adults rely on interpersonal communication and community activities. Studies also show that civic engagement and reporting behaviors tend to be stronger among the younger population, who often see human rights as part of social responsibility (Swed, 2018).

Age is also linked to willingness to report abuses. Younger individuals often demonstrate higher motivation to report due to their sense of justice and exposure to educational campaigns (Jordan, 2021). However, older adults, although experienced, may hesitate because of social fears or mistrust in authorities. Thus, age plays a dual role in determining both awareness levels and behavioral intentions toward reporting violations.

Gender

Gender differences have long been associated with variations in human rights perception and behavior. (Rudolph et.al, 2024) observed that women are more likely to report abuses due to empathy and a higher sense of social justice. Conversely, men may hesitate due to cultural expectations and fear of social judgment. This highlights how gender-based socialization shapes human rights engagement.

According to (Batista, 2023), gender not only affects awareness but also the degree of assertiveness in reporting abuses. Women who experience or witness rights violations tend to act faster than men due to their empathetic responses and perceived moral responsibility.

Gender-sensitive human rights education and supportive reporting systems can help balance this disparity and encourage equal participation across genders.

Educational Attainment

Education serves as a foundation for human rights awareness and advocacy. (Lundy & Sainz, 2018) highlighted that education significantly enhances individuals' comprehension of their legal rights and responsibilities. Higher educational attainment equips individuals with critical thinking skills that enable them to identify and respond to rights violations effectively.

(Connors, 2019) further argued that education fosters analytical reasoning, which strengthens civic participation and advocacy. People with secondary and tertiary education are more likely to join human rights campaigns and utilize institutional mechanisms for redress. A study by UNESCO (2012) also found that exposure to human rights education increases moral reasoning and promotes proactive reporting of abuses.

Moreover, education bridges the gap between awareness and action. Individuals who receive structured instruction about civic rights and justice are more capable of influencing others within their communities. Consequently, human rights education not only builds knowledge but also fosters a culture of accountability and moral responsibility (Misra, 2023).

Human Rights Awareness

Knowledge of Fundamental Rights

Knowledge of fundamental rights refers to an individual's understanding of basic civil, political, economic, social, and cultural rights guaranteed to all people. According to Nowak (2022), fundamental rights such as the right to life, equality before the law, freedom of expression, and protection from abuse form the foundation of a just and democratic society. Awareness of these rights enables individuals to recognize violations and understand when legal protections apply.

Several studies emphasize that individuals with higher knowledge of fundamental rights are more capable of identifying human rights abuses and responding appropriately. Hareket (2021) explained that human rights awareness strengthens people's sense of justice and fairness, encouraging them to oppose unlawful or abusive actions. Similarly, Dzhuska et al. (2021) classified human rights into civil, political, and socio-economic rights, stressing that understanding these categories helps individuals recognize violations beyond physical abuse, including discrimination and denial of services.

In the Philippine context, awareness of fundamental rights often remains basic and limited to concepts introduced in school or media exposure. Ismaili (2024) noted that while many Filipinos recognize basic freedoms, knowledge of due process, legal remedies, and socio-economic rights remains weak. This limited understanding affects people's ability to respond effectively to abuses, particularly among marginalized and rural populations (Reuter, 2019).

These findings suggest that strengthening knowledge of fundamental rights is essential in empowering individuals to protect themselves and others from human rights violations.

Familiarity with Reporting Mechanisms

Familiarity with reporting mechanisms refers to an individual's awareness of available legal channels, institutions, and procedures for reporting human rights abuses. According to Jordan (2021), individuals who are familiar with reporting systems are more likely to report violations because they understand where, how, and to whom complaints should be filed. Knowledge of reporting procedures reduces fear, confusion, and uncertainty when abuses occur.

Studies show that even when individuals are aware of their rights, lack of familiarity with reporting mechanisms discourages action. Castro (2019) highlighted that in many developing countries, including the Philippines, abuse reporting systems exist but remain underutilized due to limited public knowledge and access. Similarly, Palmer (2019) emphasized that distrust in institutions and lack of clarity about complaint processes weaken reporting behavior, especially among disadvantaged groups.

Local initiatives such as the Commission on Human Rights (CHR) and Barangay Violence Against Women and Children (VAWC) desks aim to provide accessible reporting channels. However, gaps remain in public awareness and implementation, particularly in rural areas (Sheikh, 2024). These studies indicate that improving familiarity with reporting mechanisms is crucial in translating human rights awareness into actual reporting behavior.

Exposure to Human-Rights-Related Information

Exposure to human-rights-related information refers to the extent to which individuals encounter human rights education through schools, media, community programs, and advocacy campaigns. Education plays a vital role in shaping human rights awareness by providing individuals with accurate information and practical knowledge about their rights and responsibilities (Lundy & Sainz, 2018).

International organizations such as the United Nations and Amnesty International have contributed significantly to raising awareness through campaigns and educational initiatives. Connors (2019) noted that sustained exposure to human rights information increases civic engagement and encourages individuals to take action against injustices. UNESCO (2012) also found that human rights education promotes moral reasoning and strengthens individuals' willingness to defend others' rights.

However, access to human-rights-related information remains unequal. Swed (2018) explained that poverty, limited education, and restricted access to media prevent many individuals from receiving consistent human rights education. In the Philippines, urban residents tend to have greater exposure to rights-related campaigns compared to those in rural areas (Reuter, 2019). These findings highlight the importance of continuous and inclusive information dissemination to improve overall human rights awareness.

Willingness to Report Human Rights Abuses

Intent to Report

Intent to report refers to an individual's willingness and decision to report a human rights violation when it occurs. The Theory of Planned Behavior suggests that intent is a strong predictor of actual behavior and is influenced by attitudes, social norms, and perceived control (Ajzen, 1991). Individuals who believe reporting is necessary and effective are more likely to take action.

Rudolph et al. (2024) found that individuals are more inclined to report physical and sexual abuses compared to other forms of neglect or misconduct. The study also revealed that women tend to show higher intent to report due to stronger empathy and moral responsibility. Similarly, Jordan (2021) emphasized that awareness of legal protections increases individuals' motivation to report violations.

Despite this, fear of retaliation, social stigma, and lack of trust in authorities continue to weaken intent to report, especially in close-knit communities (Palmer, 2019). These findings indicate that strengthening intent requires not only awareness but also supportive social and institutional environments.

Perceived Responsibility

Perceived responsibility refers to an individual's sense of moral and social obligation to report abuses and protect others from harm. According to Misra (2023), individuals with strong human rights literacy often feel responsible not only for their own safety but also for the welfare

of others. This sense of responsibility encourages proactive behavior and reduces silence in the face of abuse.

Human rights education has been shown to strengthen perceived responsibility by emphasizing shared humanity and collective accountability. Porter (2020) explained that human rights education engages both emotional and cognitive aspects, fostering empathy and ethical responsibility. Similarly, Sanders and Scanlon (2021) highlighted the role of NGOs in cultivating civic responsibility, particularly where state protection is weak.

In community settings, perceived responsibility is higher when individuals feel connected to their environment and believe their actions can make a difference (Walsh et al., 2022). These studies suggest that perceived responsibility is a key factor in encouraging individuals to report human rights abuses.

Confidence in Available Reporting Channels

Confidence in available reporting channels refers to an individual's trust in institutions and belief that reporting will lead to protection and justice. According to Palmer (2019), lack of confidence in authorities is one of the strongest barriers to reporting human rights abuses. Fear of inaction, retaliation, or corruption discourages individuals from using formal channels.

Studies show that confidence increases when reporting systems are accessible, responsive, and victim-centered. Mathews (2022) found that well-implemented reporting laws and protective measures significantly improve reporting rates. In contrast, Hardyansah et al.

(2022) observed that even when services exist, low confidence in formal institutions leads individuals to seek informal or community-based solutions.

In the Philippine context, strengthening confidence requires transparent procedures, community engagement, and responsive law enforcement. When individuals trust that reporting mechanisms will protect them and lead to action, they are more likely to report abuses and participate in upholding human rights.

1.3.Theoretical Framework

This study is anchored on the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) by Ajzen (1991) and the Human Rights–Based Approach (HRBA). The Theory of Planned Behavior explains that an individual's behavior is shaped by intention, which is influenced by attitudes, perceived social responsibility, and perceived control. In this study, human rights awareness shapes respondents' attitudes toward reporting abuses, while familiarity with reporting mechanisms and confidence in available channels influence perceived behavioral control.

The Human Rights–Based Approach emphasizes empowerment through knowledge and participation. According to HRBA, individuals who are aware of their rights are more likely to demand accountability and seek redress when violations occur. Awareness of fundamental rights, exposure to rights-related information, and familiarity with reporting mechanisms empower individuals to act and participate actively in protecting human dignity.

Together, these theories explain that higher levels of human rights awareness increase the willingness to report abuses by strengthening intent, perceived responsibility, and confidence in reporting systems.

1.4. Schematic Diagram

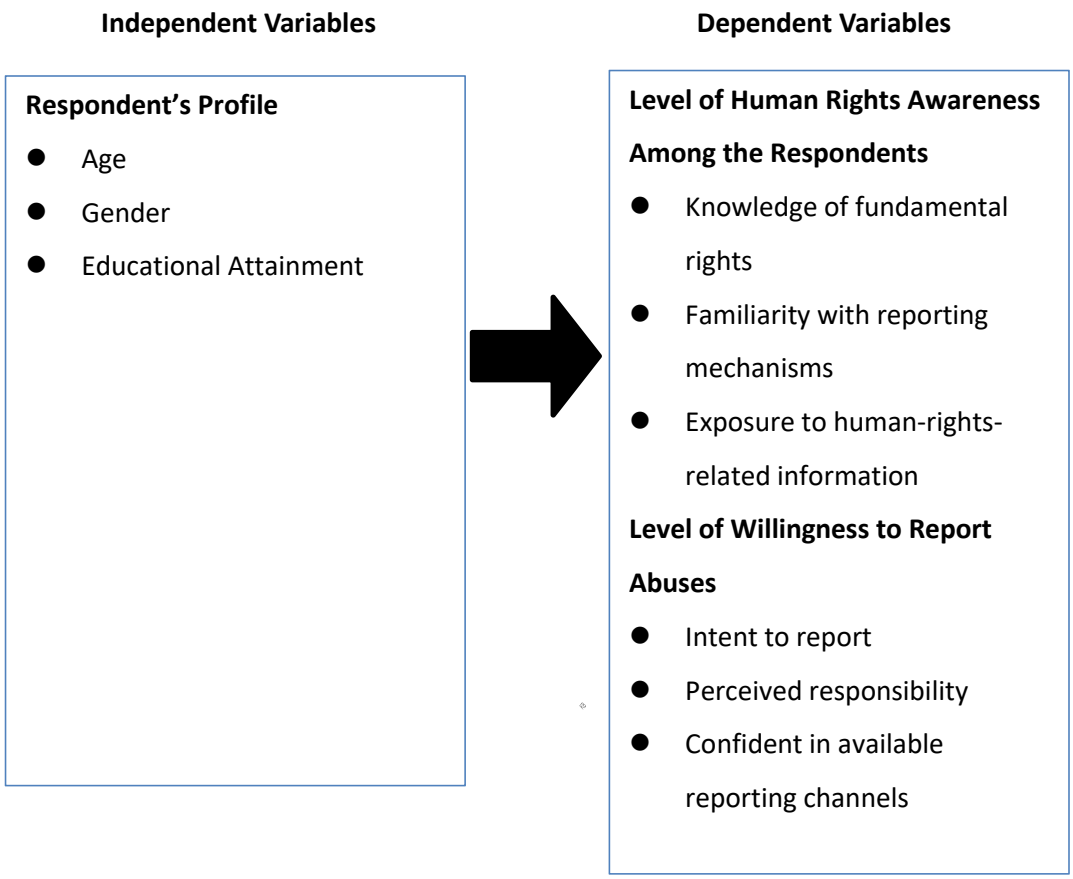


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the relationship between the dependent and independent variables of the sample.

1.7. Statement of the Problem

The Study's primary purpose was to determine the Human Rights Awareness and the Willingness to Report Abuse. It will seek to answer the following questions:

1. What is the profile of the respondents in terms of:

1.1 age;

1.2 gender; and

1.3 educational Attainment?

2. What is the level of human rights awareness among the respondents based on the following indicators:

2.1 knowledge of fundamental rights,

2.2 familiarity with reporting mechanisms; and

2.3 exposure to human-rights-related information?

3. What is the level of willingness to report human rights abuses among the respondents in terms of:

3.1 intent to report,

3.2 perceived responsibility; and

3.3 confidence in available reporting channels?

4. Is there a significant relationship between the respondent's level of human rights awareness and their willingness to report abuses?

1.8. Hypothesis

The following are the Study's hypotheses.

Ho1: There is no significant relationship between the respondent's level of human rights awareness and their willingness to report abuses.

1.10. Definition of Terms

To better understand the Study, the following terms are stated below.

Age. It refers to the number of years the respondents have lived.

Confidence in Available Reporting Channels. Refers to the level of trust respondents have in existing reporting systems and institutions to handle human rights complaints fairly, safely, and effectively.

Educational Attainment. Refers to the highest level of education completed by the respondents.

Exposure to Human Rights–Related Information. Refers to the frequency and extent to which respondents encounter information about human rights through schools, media, seminars, social networks, and community programs.

Familiarity with Reporting Mechanisms. Refers to the extent to which respondents are aware of existing institutions, offices, and procedures for reporting human rights abuses, such as barangay offices, police stations, courts, and the Commission on Human Rights (CHR).

Gender. It refers to respondents' gender identity and gender expression.

Human Rights Awareness. The level of understanding and knowledge individuals have regarding their basic rights and freedoms as guaranteed by national laws and international human rights instruments.

Intent to Report. Refers to the respondents' personal determination or decision to report human rights abuses when they witness or experience them.

Knowledge of Fundamental Rights. Refers to the respondents' understanding of basic civil, political, economic, social, and cultural rights such as the right to life, equality before the law, freedom of expression, and due process.

Perceived Responsibility. Refers to the respondents' belief that reporting human rights abuses is a moral, social, or civic duty that contributes to justice and community protection.

Willingness to Report Abuses. Refers to the readiness and inclination of individuals to inform authorities or appropriate institutions about observed or experienced human rights violations.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

2.1 Research Design

The study employed a descriptive-correlational quantitative research design. This design was appropriate because it described the level of human rights awareness and willingness to report abuses among respondents and examined the significant relationship between these variables without manipulating any condition. Quantitative methods allowed the researchers to gather numerical data that could be statistically analyzed to determine patterns and relationships.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

Research Locale

The Study will be conducted in the municipalities of Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte. The researchers will choose municipalities because they represent a mix of urban and rural communities, making them suitable areas for assessing differences in human rights awareness and reporting behavior.

Research Respondents

The respondents in the Study were 382 residents from the selected municipalities. The researchers used stratified random sampling to ensure equal representation based on age, gender, and educational background. The researchers will ensure that only individuals aged 18

or older are included in the survey. The selection ensured diversity and fairness in data representation.

Sampling Technique

The researchers used stratified random sampling. The population was divided into strata based on barangay, age, gender, and educational attainment. From each stratum, respondents were randomly selected to ensure proportional and fair representation across Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte.

Research Instrument

The primary instrument used was a researcher-made survey questionnaire divided into four parts:

Part I covered the respondents' profile, including age, gender, and educational attainment. Part II measured human rights awareness in terms of knowledge of fundamental rights, familiarity with reporting mechanisms, and exposure to human-rights-related information. Part III measured willingness to report abuses in terms of intent to report, perceived responsibility, and confidence in reporting channels. Part IV contained additional items for clarification and validation. The questionnaire used a five-point Likert scale and was validated by subject experts before administration.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

The environment of the study consists of respondents from the three towns who answered the survey questionnaires. The total population from the three towns was 47,424 with the sample size of 382. This study used the stratified random sampling procedure to get the number of respondents under each barangay coming from three municipalities of Agusan del Norte.

2.5 Research Data and Analysis Plan

The data collected for the Study, *"Human Rights Awareness and Willingness to Report Abuses: A Quantitative Study,"* were organized, analyzed, and interpreted using simple statistical tools to ensure the results were presented accurately and clearly. The researchers used frequency, percentage, and mean to describe the respondents' profiles and to measure their level of awareness and willingness to report human rights abuses.

Table 1. Distribution of Respondents According to Barangay (N=47424, n=382)

BARANGAY	Population			Sample					
	Male	Female	Total	Male		Female		Total	
	F	F	F	f	%	f	%	f	%
ROJALES	832	799	1631	7	1.8	6	1.6	13	3.4
SAN AGUSTIN	389	379	768	3	0.8	3	0.8	6	1.6
VINAPOR	798	730	1528	6	1.6	6	1.6	12	3.1
TAGCATONG	1205	1202	2407	10	2.6	10	2.6	20	5.2
POBLACION	12880	6742	19622	104	27.2	54	14.1	158	41.4

AGONG ONG	533	540	1073	4	1.0	4	1.0	8	2.1
BRGY 3 BUENAVISTA	1324	1345	2669	11	2.9	11	2.9	22	5.8
SACOL	1065	1061	2126	8	2.1	9	2.4	17	4.5
BRGY 9 BUENAVISTA	598	586	1184	5	1.3	5	1.3	10	2.6
GUINABSAN	2055	1918	3973	16	4.2	15	3.9	31	8.1
APAGAN	669	578	1247	5	1.3	5	1.3	10	2.6
BRGY 4 NASIPIT	618	768	1386	5	1.3	6	1.6	11	2.9
BRGY TALISAY	1926	2039	3965	16	4.2	17	4.5	33	8.6
BRGY TRIANGULO	1084	1215	2299	9	2.4	10	2.6	19	5.0
BRGY PUNTA	767	779	1546	6	1.6	6	1.6	12	3.1
Total	26743	20681	47424	215	56.3	167	43.7	382	100.0

To show how respondents were distributed across different barangays, the researchers used frequency and percentage. This made it easier to see how many participants came from each barangay and to ensure that every community was fairly represented. A stratified sampling method was applied to achieve this balance.

To analyze the responses regarding human rights awareness and willingness to report abuses, the researchers used the mean. This helped determine the average level of agreement among the respondents based on their survey answers. Each statement was rated using a five-point Likert scale, where:

5 means Strongly Agree

4 means Agree

3 means Neutral

2 means Disagree

1 means Strongly Disagree

The following formulas were used in processing the data:

Percentage:

$$P = (f / N) \times 100$$

where P stands for percentage, f for the number of responses, and N for the total number of respondents.

Mean:

$$\bar{X} = (\Sigma X) / N$$

where $\bar{X}$ represents the mean, ΣX the sum of all responses, and N the total number of respondents.

By using these simple statistical methods, the researchers were able to present the data clearly and meaningfully. It allowed them to see how aware the respondents were of their human rights and how willing they were to report abuses when they occurred. The results provided valuable insights that could promote a stronger sense of responsibility and participation in protecting human rights within the community.

2.6 Research Ethical Standards

A. Protection of Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

This research complies with all rules regarding ownership of ideas. No invention, method, or technology that could be patented came from it. Still, the tools used in the survey, the model guiding the Study, and the methods for analyzing data are covered by copyright in the Philippines (RA 8293). Books, papers, and web sources pulled from others were cited correctly to give credit where it's due, while avoiding copying. No symbols or brand names were made that need legal trademark protection.

B. Informed Consent

Respondents in Buenavista, Nasipit, and Carmen, Agusan del Norte, received clear details on what the Study aimed to do, why it mattered, how it would run, and their rights before joining. Instead of signing anything right away, they received a printed form explaining that taking part was optional, and that they could leave whenever they wanted without facing consequences. To help them fully grasp everything, the document avoided complex terms and kept it easy to follow. Minors weren't involved at any point, nor were people in vulnerable situations; moreover, no animals were involved in this work, so animal ethics approval didn't apply.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

This research complied with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173) in all respects. Names, ages, genders, and education levels remained completely private. To avoid identifying

participants, info was stripped of identifiers when entered into systems. Digital records were password-protected and accessible only to the research team. Paper copies were placed in sealed envelopes and stored in locked cabinets. Only after clear permission would anonymized details be passed on strictly for scholarly use.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

People chose to join the Study on their own. They got told they could say no or leave anytime, no problem. No cash rewards or pressure tactics were used at all. Joining came down entirely to whether someone wanted to help out for school reasons.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

A careful check made sure participants wouldn't face mental, emotional, or bodily harm. Survey items remained neutral, avoided intrusion, and honored basic respect for people. Individuals were told upfront that they could pass on any question, causing unease. Since there were no at-risk populations or delicate procedures, the risks remained extremely low. Animals weren't used here, so ideas like Replacement, Reduction, and Refinement didn't apply.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

The Study adds social worth by checking how well people know their rights and how likely they are to speak up about violations. As a result, officials might design more effective awareness campaigns and boost confidence in reporting channels. Even though those involved didn't get physical rewards, their input helps clarify how rights education works locally. If asked, they can be sent a brief version of the results once everything's wrapped up.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants were selected using a method that evenly balanced age, gender, and education across the three municipalities. Those taking part had to be 18 or older—no exceptions. Nobody was treated unfairly during selection, whether left out or brought in. Fairness was built into how folks were chosen, keeping things neutral and avoiding favoritism toward any group.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Data collection, tallying, or analysis will follow established methods to ensure the results are trustworthy. The team entered responses by hand, then double checked them. It helped avoid mistakes or repeats. Frequency counts, percentages, or weighted averages made up the main number crunching, all done the same way throughout. Issues like self-reporting flaws? They were called out openly, just so the research stays honest.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

All results were shared exactly as found, with no changes or data manipulation. Negative outcomes came through just as the good ones did, keeping things honest. Every tool, code base, or source used received proper credit, no exceptions. The team confirmed they had no personal interests that would affect the work.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The research relied on previously published sources and open-access references suitable for scholarly work. Every resource, whether from web pages or printed books, received proper APA-style credit. Instead of patented tools, common academic methods were applied. Also, the software used didn't require anything beyond regular licenses, so no extra permissions were needed.

K. Ethical Considerations for Human Subjects

Human participants were the only subjects involved. They were fully informed about the minimal risks, potential benefits, and the voluntary nature of their participation. No deception or manipulation occurred, and participants were protected from any form of harm or prejudice. The Study complied with the ethical research standards of Saint Michael College of Caraga and national research guidelines.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

AI helpers like ChatGPT lent a hand by sorting early thoughts, fixing sentence flow, or shortening rough parts—guided by the research team. Outputs made by AI didn't count as core results. Researchers double-checked every AI-supported piece to ensure the findings were accurate. Participants' personal details never came into contact with AI tools, ensuring privacy remained intact.

M. Ethical Approval and Institutional Clearance

This Study received approval from the Institutional Research Ethics Review Board (IRERB) of Saint Michael College before gathering any information. It ensured the work complied with

school rules regarding protecting people involved, keeping data private, and respecting ownership of ideas. Info gathering began once official permission was granted during the 2025–2026 school year.

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